Specification of the protected designation of origin “CORNAS”

approved by the order of 4 July 2024, published in the JORF of 9 July 2024

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin “Cornas”, initially recognised by the decree of 5 August 1938.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

No specific provision.

III. – Colour and types of product

The controlled designation of origin “Cornas” is reserved for still red wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification and the elaboration of the wines are carried out within the territory of the commune of Cornas, in the Ardèche department, on the basis of the official geographic code as at 1 January 2019.

2° – Delimited parcel area

The grapes come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the session of the competent national committee of 12 May 1971.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town hall of the commune referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification of the wines, is made up of the territory of the following communes, on the basis of the official geographic code as at 1 January 2019:

Ardèche department: Alboussière, Andance, Ardoix, Arlebosc, Arras-sur-Rhône, Boffres, Bogy, Champagne, Champis, Charmes-sur-Rhône, Charnas, Châteaubourg, Cheminas, Colombier-le- Cardinal, Eclassan, Etables, Félines, Gilhac-et-Bruzac, Glun, Guilherand-Granges, Lemps, Limony, Mauves, Ozon, Peaugres, Peyraud, Plats, Quintenas, Saint-Barthélemy-le-Plain, Saint-Cyr, Saint- Georges-les-Bains, Saint-Romain-d’Ay, Saint-Romain-de-Lerps, Sarras, Sécheras, Serrières, Saint- Désirat, Saint-Etienne-de-Valoux, Saint-Jean-de-Muzols, Saint-Péray, Soyons, Talencieux, Thorrenc, Toulaud, Tournon-sur-Rhône, Vernosc-lès-Annonay, Vinzieux, Vion ; Cahier des charges de l’appellation d’origine protégée « CORNAS » homologué par l’arrêté du 4 juillet 2024. , publié au JORF du 9 juillet 2024 Publié au BO du MASA le 25 juillet 2024 2/12

Drôme department: Albon, Andancette, Beaumont-Monteux, Beausemblant, Bourg-lès- Valence, Chanos-Curson, Chantemerle-les-Blés, Châteauneuf-sur-Isère, Chavannes, Clérieux, Crozes- Hermitage, Erôme, Gervans, Granges-les-Beaumont, Larnage, Laveyron, Mercurol-Veaunes, La Motte- de-Galaure, Ponsas, Pont-de-l’Isère, La Roche-de-Glun, Saint-Barthélemy-de-Vals, Saint- Donat-sur- l’Herbasse, Saint-Rambert-d’Albon, Saint-Uze, Saint-Vallier, Serves-sur-Rhône, Tain- l’Hermitage, Triors, Valence

Isère department: Chonas-l’Amballan, Le-Péage-de-Roussillon, Reventin-Vaugris, Les Roches-de-Condrieu, Sablons, Saint-Alban-du-Rhône, Saint-Clair-du-Rhône, Saint-Maurice-l’Exil, Salaise-sur-Sanne, Seyssuel, Vienne

Loire department: Bessey, La Chapelle-Villars, Chavanay, Chuyer, Lupé, Maclas, Malleval, Pélussin, Roisey, Saint-Michel-sur-Rhône, Saint-Pierre-de-Bœuf, Saint-Romain-en-Jarez, Vérin

Rhône department: Ampuis, Condrieu, Les Haies, Loire-sur-Rhône, Longes, Saint-Cyr-sur-le- Rhône, Saint-Romain-en-Gal, Sainte-Colombe, Tupin-et-Semons

V. – Grape varieties

The wines come from the syrah N variety.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density.
- The vines present a minimum planting density of 4,400 plants per hectare; - Each plant has a maximum area of 2.30 square metres; this area is obtained by multiplying the inter-row and inter-plant distances within the same row; - The vines present a spacing between rows less than or equal to 2.50 metres.

b) – Pruning rules.
The vines are pruned with a maximum of 8 free eyes (buds) per plant, according to the following techniques: - short spur pruning (goblet, Royat cordon with one or two arms); - single or double Guyot pruning. The maximum height of the cordon is 0.60 metre. This height is measured from the ground to the lower part of the framework arms.

c) – Trellising, foliage-height and staking-height rules.
The vines are trained either on stakes or in “raised single-plane trellising”: - For vines trained in “raised single-plane trellising”, the height of the trellised foliage is at least equal to 0.6 times the spacing between rows. The height of trellised foliage is measured between the lower limit of the foliage, established at least 0.30 metre above the ground, and the upper topping limit; - For vines trained on stakes, the staking height is at least 1.50 metre. This height is measured between the ground level and the top of the stake.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel.
The average maximum load per parcel is fixed at 7,000 kilograms per hectare.

e) – Thresholds for missing vines.
The percentage of dead or missing vine plants, referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, is fixed at 20 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine.
The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2° – Other cultivation practices

From 1 January 2020, vine plantings and replacements are carried out with plant material that has been the subject of a hot-water treatment or of any other treatment recognised by the Ministry responsible for Agriculture to combat flavescence dorée.

In order to preserve the characteristics of the physical and biological environment that constitutes a fundamental element of the terroir: - On the parcels apt for the production of the controlled designation of origin, the works for controlling water flow and the elements ensuring the integrity and durability of the soils (low walls, terraces, banks, etc.) are maintained according to usage; - Only developments or works that do not bring a substantial modification of the structuring elements (low walls, terraces, embankments, banks, etc.) of a parcel of the delimited parcel area are authorised; - The control of the spontaneous vegetation is carried out, from 1 September to 1 February, either by soil tillage or by equipment ensuring a precise localisation of the treatment products; - Plastic mulching of the vines is prohibited; - The weeding of the headlands and embankments, other than mechanical weeding, is prohibited.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

a) – The wines come from grapes harvested at proper ripeness.

b) – Particular harvesting provisions. The wines come from manually harvested grapes.

c) – Particular provisions for transport of the harvest. The bunches of grapes are transported whole to the place of vinification.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

a) – Sugar richness of the grapes. Grapes presenting a sugar content lower than 171 grams per litre of must may not be considered as being at proper ripeness.

b) – Minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume. The wines present a minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume of 10.5 %.

VIII. – Yields. – Entry into production

1° – Yield

The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 40 hectolitres per hectare.

2° – Limit yield

The limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 46 hectolitres per hectare.

3° – Loss of the benefit of the controlled designation of origin

The wines are obtained within the limit of a yield of 50 hectolitres per hectare. This yield corresponds to the total production of the claimed parcels. Any exceeding of this yield causes the whole of the harvest to lose the benefit of the controlled designation of origin.

4° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may be granted to wines coming from:

- parcels of young vines only from the 3rd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July;

- parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July;

- parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By way of derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the grape varieties of each parcel concerned.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local usages.

a) – Malolactic fermentation. The wines present, at the packaging stage, a malic acid content less than or equal to 0.4 gram per litre.

b) – Analytical standards. At the packaging stage, the wines present a content of fermentable sugars (glucose and fructose): - less than or equal to 3 grams per litre, for wines presenting a natural alcoholic strength by volume less than or equal to 13.5 %; - less than or equal to 4 grams per litre, for wines presenting a natural alcoholic strength by volume greater than 13.5 %.

c) – Oenological practices and physical treatments. - Any thermal treatment of the harvest involving a temperature greater than 40 °C is prohibited; - The use of pieces of wood is prohibited; - The wines do not exceed, after enrichment, a total alcoholic strength by volume of 13.5 %.

d) – Prohibited equipment. Continuous presses are prohibited.

e) – Vat capacity. Every operator has a vinification vat capacity at least equal to 0.8 times the product of the yield referred to at 1° of point VIII by the area of the vines intended to be vinified at the cellar.

f) – Overall upkeep of the cellar and equipment. The cellar (floor and walls) and the vinification equipment present a good general condition of upkeep.

2° – Provisions relating to packaging

a) – The wines are placed on the market for the consumer only in glass bottles.

b) – For each packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body: - the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code; - an analysis carried out before or after packaging. The analysis reports are kept for a period of 6 months from the date of packaging.

3° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator demonstrates an identified place for the storage of the packaged products.

4° – Provisions relating to the movement of products and to placing on the market for the consumers

The wines are placed on the market for the consumer according to the provisions of Article D. 645-17 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

In the organisation of the controlled designations of origin of the Rhône Valley, the controlled designation of origin “Cornas” is part of the “Crus des Côtes du Rhône”. Inscribed within the northern part of the controlled designation of origin “Côtes du Rhône”, the controlled designation of origin “Cornas” is the most southern thereof for the production of red wines. The vineyard is situated, indeed, on the right bank of the Rhône, opposite the town of Valence, and is enclosed between the geographical areas of the controlled designations of origin “Saint-Péray” and “Saint-Joseph”.

The geographical area is delimited over the sole commune of Cornas, in the Ardèche department. The territory is very open to the south, and well protected from the north by the massif of the Arlettes. In this amphitheatre, the vineyard benefits from a temperate climate of “Lyonnais” type, strongly nuanced by a south exposure and a natural shelter (relief) against the north wind.

The essential part of the vineyard is established on soils arising from the weathering of Primary eruptive rocks of the granite family (porphyroid granites of Tournon). To the north of the commune, a fragment of sedimentary deposits of the Secondary era (the massif of the Arlettes) constitutes the frontier with the controlled designation of origin “Saint-Joseph”. This massif of compact limestones has been eroded and has released, on its southern slope, scree, notably present in the quarter “Pied-la-Vigne”. This portion of the vineyard, on limestone scree, concerns only a tiny part of the geographical area. On these few limestone scree areas, as on the granitic slopes, the vines colonise steep slopes, implying, in order to hold the granitic arenas in place, cultivation on small terraces separated by low walls traditionally of dry stone which the winegrowers have known and continue to preserve. On the more alluvial soils, situated at the foot of the hillsides, the vineyard extends over more extensive parcels. Finally, more recently, the vineyard has conquered the hills situated beyond 250 metres of altitude. The controlled designation of origin “Cornas” has built its renown solely on red wine, in parallel with “Saint-Péray”, the neighbouring controlled designation of origin, which recognises only white wine.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

According to the authors of antiquity (PLINY and PLUTARCH), viticulture in this region is at least two thousand years old. The oldest written traces of this cultivation on the exact place of Cornas go back at least to the 10th century (year 1000: mention of the gift of a vine to a canon, in the cartulary of the abbey of Saint-Chaffre du Monastier). The production and marketing of wine is attested, for its part, between the 5th and 10th century by Eugène de ROZIÈRE (Recueil général des formules usitées dans l’empire des

Francs — Part 3 — 1859 edition). Indeed, among the commodities passing through Soyons, then port of the Vivarais, the author cites "…wines, above all those of Saint-Péray, of Cornas".

Until 1461, the Rhône constitutes a real frontier, for the Dauphiné is not yet attached to France. In fact, the wines of the region of Cornas, like all the wines of the region of the Vivarais (Ardèche), are essentially marketed in the hinterland, on the right bank of the Rhône, and this thanks to the muleteers who cross the mountains in the direction of the Gévaudan, the Velay and as far as the Auvergne. The wine then serves as currency of exchange against the wheat of these lands. From the reign of Louis XVI, after the wars of religion which disturb the regional economy and thanks to the attachment of the Dauphiné to France, the vineyard can finally develop and be exported to the Dauphiné. Like all the wines of the Rhône Valley, "Cornas" knows difficulties in reaching Paris by the Rhône river because of heavy taxes put in place, notably by the towns of Lyon and Mâcon, on the wines coming "from below". At the end of the 18th century, the opening of the Briare Canal makes it possible to link the Loire to the Seine, thus opening the Parisian market.

From this period, the references to the excellence of the wines of "Cornas", and to their renown, are numerous and constant over time. In the 17th century, the consular accounts of Bourg-lès-Valence report "20 pounds for a piece of wine of Cornas" offered to Mr La CONDAMINE, lieutenant of the citadel (municipal archives of Bourg CC38). Much later written traces still mention, explicitly, the wine produced at "Cornas". In 1781, notably, an inventory of the goods inherited by the nephew of the late Jacques-Philippe de ROBERT DE LATOUR, canon of Saint-Bernard, reports "wine of Cornas" in his cellars.

On 19 November 1937, the controlled designation of origin "Côtes du Rhône" is recognised for the wines from a large number of viticultural communes of the Rhône Valley situated between Ampuis and Avignon, among which figures the commune of Cornas. Quickly, the local human community organises itself with the aim of obtaining recognition as a controlled designation of origin for the wines of "Cornas". F. MICHEL, then mayor of the commune, H. ASTRUC, director of the oenological station of the Gard, and Baron LEROY, president of the "General Union of the Winegrowers of the Côtes du Rhône", are considered as the founding fathers of the controlled designation of origin "Cornas" obtained by decree of 5 August 1938.

At this period, the wines are above all vinified by the local trade (DELAS and VERILHAC houses). The first bottling on behalf of a private cellar takes place only in 1952, that is to say 14 years after the recognition as a controlled designation of origin. In 1980, some twenty producers vinify and package. Since then, a certain balance has been established within the profession, and the wines of the private cellars (some sixty) rub shoulders with those of the trade and of the nearest cooperative cellar (Tain-l'Hermitage). Moreover, whereas traditionally the winegrowers became, through marriages, reciprocally owners of parcels on "Saint-Péray" and "Cornas", today other winegrowers or merchants from more distant vineyards ("Crozes-Hermitage", "Saint-Joseph") come to rent or buy vines at Cornas. In 2021, the vineyard covers an area of about 160 hectares for an average annual production of 5,000 hectolitres. The proximity of the Valence conurbation generates a strong pressure on the land, but the winegrowers organise themselves and redouble their efforts in order to preserve this heritage and the viticultural potential of the controlled designation of origin.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the product

The wines are exclusively red wines, "Cornas" being the only controlled designation of origin of the whole of the designations known as those of the "northern Côtes du Rhône" where the wine is produced exclusively from the syrah N variety. The syrah N variety, or "serine" at Ampuis, is also called locally "Plant de l'Ermitage". The vineyard of the controlled designation of origin "Hermitage" being situated 12 kilometres to the north of Cornas, the syrah N variety is therefore indeed an emblematic variety of this territory.

The wines always present a very dark robe, garnet, or even almost black, characteristic, evolving towards amber tonalities with ageing. They are powerful and full-bodied and reach their apogee after a long keeping. In reference to this structure, they are often qualified as "virile". As early as 1819, the "Nouveau manuel complet du sommelier et du marchand de vin" of P. MAIGNE already gives a very complete characterisation of the product: "they are rich in colour, have much body, marrow, velvet, solidity".

3° – Causal interactions

On the right bank of the Rhône, the vineyard, established since the Roman period, constitutes the western part of the territory of the Allobroges. The geographical area of the controlled designation of origin "Cornas" delimits an essentially granitic amphitheatre, well exposed, protected from the winds, and hot, offering hillsides developed into terraces supported by low walls that the winegrowing community has known how to put in place patiently and continues to protect, anxious to preserve both the production potential and the associated landscape. By preserving the tradition of manual harvest of the grapes, the winegrowers of "Cornas" contribute to preserving the originality and the characteristics of this hillside vineyard.

The mesoclimate is perhaps the founding element of the name of the commune of the controlled designation of origin, since in Celtic, "Cornas" means "burnt earth". These clement climatic conditions allow an early ripeness which explains that, although situated only 12 kilometres to the south of the territory of the controlled designation of origin "Hermitage", the harvest often begins, at "Cornas", one week earlier. The whole of these natural conditions has enabled people to establish here the syrah N variety, a variety that remains emblematic of this territory, even if it has escaped to other regions. The grapes, from carefully delimited parcels, are early ripe and offer virile wines characterised by a black robe, abundant but silky tannins, powerful aromas, a structure ensuring wines for keeping, of a quality unanimously and worldwide recognised, praised over the centuries as the abundant archives testify. Beyond its organoleptic characteristics, the reduced size of its vineyard and its climate, "Cornas" draws its originality and its identity from its unity (a single commune, a single variety, essentially granitic soils).

Horace-Bénédict DE SAUSSURE (1740-1799) offers us, in Volume 3 of his "Voyages dans les Alpes", a striking testimony on the originality of the wine and of the vineyard of "Cornas" which remain topical 200 years later. Indeed, he writes: "the vines of this place, worked in the rising sun, on the slope of the mountain, produce a dark red wine which also has reputation". The letters of Count Camille DE TOURNON, prefect of Rome from 1809 to 1814, addressed to his family, attest that the wine of "Cornas" was appreciated by the privileged classes, notably in Rome: "I have just learned that the ship that carried my wine of Cornas was lost on the coast of Genoa", and in a second letter: "You would please me by sending me 200 bottles of Cornas and of Saint-Péray, these wines are a success here". Later still, "Cornas" remains associated with excellence or esteem. Thus the "Revue des vins et liqueurs et produits de l'exportation", edited by Paul DREYFUS BING in 1877, evokes concerning "Cornas" "the elite of the great fine wines of the Côte du Rhône".

At the end of the 19th century, the sources praising the quality and the renown of "Cornas" multiply. In 1893, A. CHARRA relates a banquet of the mobiles of the 3rd battalion of the Ardèche in these terms: "Monsieur Francon of Saint-Péray had had the kindness to supply the tables with his excellent Cornas". Up to the definitions provided by Larousse in 1866 and Littré in 1886, which give respectively: "Cornas: …this commune comprises 100 hectares of vines producing a much-esteemed red wine" and "Cornas: an esteemed wine of a cru between Saint-Péray and Tournon". Closer to us, finally, in the work entitled "Miéjour: paysages du Rhône, Dauphiné, Languedoc, Provence…", F. GRÉGOIRE does not hesitate to speak of "heroic crus" and of wines "the most beautiful in the world" for the red wines of "Cornas" and the white wines of its neighbour "Saint-Péray".

XI. – Transitional measures

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density. The vine parcels in place on 31 July 2009 and not meeting the provisions relating to the minimum planting density and to the spacing between rows or the spacing between plants within the same row continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin, until they are grubbed up, provided that the foliage height makes it possible to have 1.40 square metre of external surface of plant cover for the production of one kilogram of grapes.

b) – Pruning rules. The provision relating to the height of the cordon does not apply to the vine parcels in place on 31 July 2009.

2° – Other cultivation practices

The provision relating to the prohibition of plastic mulching does not apply to the plantings carried out before 31 July 2009.

3° – Packaging

The provision relating to the obligation to place the wines on the market for the consumer in glass bottles applies from 1 August 2016.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin "Cornas" is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered.

2° – Particular provisions

a) – The labelling of the wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the name of a smaller geographical unit, provided that: - it is a registered cadastral lieu-dit; - it appears on the harvest declaration.

b) – The labelling of the wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the larger geographical unit "Cru des Côtes du Rhône" or "Vignobles de la Vallée du Rhône". The conditions of use of the larger geographical unit "Vignobles de la Vallée du Rhône" are specified by the agreement signed between the various defence and management bodies concerned. This term must appear in the same visual field as all the compulsory indications, and be printed in characters of the same graphics and the same colour as those of the appellation, without the dimensions of this term exceeding two-thirds of those of the appellation.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Declaration of renunciation to produce

Every operator declares to the defence and management body, according to the arrangements defined in the control plan, the parcels for which it renounces to produce the controlled designation of origin. The declaration of renunciation to produce is drawn up according to the model defined by the defence and management body. The defence and management body transmits this declaration to the approved control body as soon as possible.

2. Claim declaration

The claim declaration is sent to the defence and management body at least fifteen days before the first bulk transaction or bulk sale to the consumer, or before the first packaging, and at the latest five days after the deadline for lodging the harvest declaration. The claim declaration is drawn up according to the model defined by the defence and management body. It indicates: - the designation claimed; - the volume of wine; - the EVV or SIRET number; - the name and address of the applicant; - the place of storage of the wine.

3. Declaration of bulk transaction or of bulk sale to the consumer and declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine

A declaration of bulk transaction, or a declaration of bulk sale to the consumer, is sent to the approved control body according to the arrangements defined in the control plan. This declaration specifies, where applicable, whether the non-packaged wine is intended to be dispatched outside the national territory. This declaration is drawn up according to the model defined by the approved control body.

4. Packaging declaration

Every operator having carried out a packaging of a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin must make, to the approved control body, a packaging declaration according to the arrangements defined in the control plan. The packaging declaration is drawn up according to the model defined by the approved control body.

5. Fallback (repli) declaration (marketing under a more general appellation)

Every operator carrying out a fallback of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin makes the declaration thereof to the defence and management body and to the approved control body according to the arrangements defined in the control plan. This declaration is drawn up according to the model defined by the defence and management body.

6. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin makes the declaration thereof to the defence and management body and to the approved control body according to the arrangements defined in the control plan. This declaration is drawn up according to the model defined by the defence and management body.

7. Declaration relating to the modification of the structuring elements of the parcels

Before any development or any works modifying the structuring elements (low walls, terraces, embankments, banks, etc.) of a delimited parcel, a declaration is sent by the operator to the defence and management body according to the arrangements defined in the control plan. The defence and management body transmits, without delay, a copy of this declaration to the services of the National Institute of Origin and Quality. This declaration is drawn up according to the model defined by the defence and management body.

II. – Keeping of registers

No specific provision.

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A1 – Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area	Documentary checks (up-to-date parcel record) and checks in the field if necessary
A2 – Claimable production potential (grape varieties, monitoring of transitional measures, planting density and trellising)	Documentary checks and checks in the field
A3 – Processing, ageing, packaging and storage facilities	
Place of vinification	Documentary checks and on-site checks
Identified storage place for the packaged products	Documentary checks and checks in the field
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard. — Pruning	Checks in the field
Average maximum load per parcel	Checks in the field
Cultivation condition and other cultivation practices	Checks in the field or documentary
B2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes. — Particular harvesting provisions	Documentary checks and checks in the field
Ripeness of the grapes	Documentary checks and checks in the field

B3 – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage. — Oenological practices or treatments (enrichment, prohibited practices…)	Documentary checks and checks in the field
Packaging	Checks in the field
B4 – Harvest declaration and claim declaration	
Missing vines	Documentary checks (register keeping) and checks in the field
Authorised yield	Documentary checks (check of declarations, monitoring of the authorised derogations)
VSI, volumes harvested in excess of the authorised yield	Documentary checks (monitoring of destruction certificates)
Claim declaration	Documentary checks and checks in the field (compliance with the arrangements and deadlines, consistency with the harvest declaration, production declaration, etc.). Control of the placing into circulation of the products
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
Non-packaged wines moving between approved warehouse keepers, at transaction	Analytical and organoleptic examination
Wines ready to be placed on the market for the consumer, before or after packaging	Analytical and organoleptic examination
Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all the lots

II – References concerning the control structure

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The check of compliance with the present specification is carried out on the basis of an approved control plan and by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence, having received delegation from the INAO.